

Hands-On-Learning: Build a Governance RACI Matrix

Learning Objectives

By the end of this activity, learners will be able to:

- Translate governance roles from a theoretical model into a practical project management tool.
 - Use a project management tool (ClickUp) to create a RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) matrix.
 - Assign specific ISMS implementation and oversight tasks to defined roles to ensure clarity and accountability.
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Description

This activity simulates a foundational step in establishing any governance program: defining who does what. Learners will step into the role of a compliance coordinator and use ClickUp to build a RACI matrix. This exercise provides a direct, hands-on application of the concepts taught in Module 1, transforming the principles of leadership engagement and role assignment into a tangible, actionable project artifact essential for a successful ISO 27001 rollout.

Structure of the Activity

Title: Build a Governance RACI Matrix

Tool used:

ClickUp

Scenario

You are the new Compliance Coordinator at "Nexus Innovations," a tech startup preparing for its first ISO 27001 audit. There is confusion among the technical, management, and executive teams about who is responsible for key information security tasks. Your CISO has asked you to create a clear RACI matrix in ClickUp to define ownership for the ISMS, ensuring everyone understands their role before the audit process begins.

Objective

To use ClickUp to draft a clear and actionable governance RACI matrix that assigns leadership, implementation, and review roles across the organization's security program, ensuring clarity and accountability during the ISO 27001 rollout.



Instructions for learners

1 Preparation:

Log in to your ClickUp account.

Create a new List or Folder named "ISMS Governance."

Inside, create a new List View. You will use tasks and custom fields to build your matrix.

2 Matrix Setup:

Create custom fields for your "RACI" columns. Go to "Show" -> "+ Add Column" -> "New Field." Create a "Dropdown" custom field for each of the following roles: CISO, IT Manager, CEO, and Legal Counsel.

For each Dropdown field, add the options: "Responsible," "Accountable," "Consulted," and "Informed."

In the main task column, list the following ISMS activities:

Define ISMS Scope
Approve Information Security Policy
Conduct Risk Assessment
Implement Access Controls
Report on ISMS Performance to the Board
Manage Security Incidents

3 Assigning Roles:

For each ISMS activity (task), go across the row and assign a RACI value for each role (column).

For example, for "Approve Information Security Policy," the CEO might be "Accountable," the CISO "Responsible," and Legal Counsel "Consulted."

Ensure every activity has at least one "Responsible" and one "Accountable" role assigned.

Organize Information Following This Structure for Peer Review

Title Page: Project title, your name, date.

RACI Matrix Screenshot: Provide a clear screenshot of your completed RACI matrix from ClickUp.

Justification: In a short paragraph, explain your reasoning for assigning "Accountable" vs. "Responsible" for the "Conduct Risk Assessment" task. Why did you choose the roles you did?

Business Alignment: Explain how this RACI matrix helps achieve clear accountability and supports a smooth ISO 27001 audit process at Nexus Innovations.

Instructions for Documenting and Sharing the Project for Peer Review

Document the Project



Use word processing software to create your report. Insert the screenshot directly into your document. Ensure all sections of the project structure are completed. Proofread your report for clarity.

Share the Project



Save your report in PDF format. Upload your document to the “Peer Review” area in the course shell. Provide a brief description of your project in the submission post.



Peer Review

Review the projects submitted by your peers and provide constructive feedback on their work.

This activity gives learners a chance to apply the lesson by creating a fundamental governance artifact that clarifies ownership, reduces confusion, and establishes a clear framework for accountability within an ISMS.